



Solution Guide: Let's Talk to John

In this activity, you used the program `john the ripper` to crack the passwords for several users on the system.

Solutions

1. Make a copy of the `/etc/shadow` file in your `/home/sysadmin` directory. Name the copy: `"shadow_copy"`.
2. Use Nano to edit your `"shadow_copy"` file to leave only the rows for the following users you will crack: Jack, Adam, Billy, Sally, Max.

- `cd /home/sysadmin`
- `sudo cp /etc/shadow shadow_copy`
- Run `sudo nano shadow_copy` and delete all extra lines that are not the above users.
- Note: `ctrl-k` will delete the current line in Nano.
- Your edited file should be similar to this:

```
max:$6$WhPNYTYJx2jx25x$QWY.....
```

```
billy:$6$Q.zRCddM9cwb5YUJh.....
```

- `jack:$6$IllqVoXkja6GG8PK$t....`
3. Run `sudo john shadow_copy`.
 4. This will take some time, but let John the Ripper run, and take note of any passwords you find.
- You should be able to crack the following passwords fairly quickly:

- `jack : lakers`
- `adam : welcome`
- `billy: football`
- `sally : 123456`
- `max : welcome`

Note: Since we use `sudo cp /etc/shadow shadow_copy`, `shadow_copy` will be owned by root and have the same permissions as the original.

Therefore, we have to use `sudo nano` and `sudo john`. Alternatively, we could have changed the ownership of `shadow_copy` with `sudo chown sysadmin:sysadmin shadow_copy`, and then not have to use `sudo` for `nano` or `john`.